

Group Detective

Your group has something in common that nobody knows yet. Find it.

GROUPS OF 3–5 · 10–15 MINUTES · PENCILS ONLY · NO PREP — ONE SHEET PER GROUP

THE CASE: somewhere in this group hides something you all share — a habit, a fear, a tiny joy. Ask, compare, interrogate. When every member matches, the case is solved.

1. What's something you do every single night before falling asleep?

2. What sound instantly puts you in a good mood?

3. What's a small thing you're afraid of that most people aren't?

4. What's a rule at your house that other houses don't seem to have?

5. What's something tiny that made you happy this week?

6. What do you always notice about a room that nobody else notices?

CASE SOLVED

We all... _____

Signed by the whole squad: _____

Teacher's Quick Guide

Group Detective — everything useful, nothing else.

WHY IT WORKS

It's social-emotional learning wearing a trench coat. Finding a real, specific commonality builds group identity faster than any icebreaker about favorite colors.

HOW TO RUN IT

One sheet per group. The case brief on the sheet does the explaining. Your only job is to enforce the 'every member matches' rule.

PUSH PAST THE OBVIOUS

If a group 'solves' the case in one minute ('we all breathe'), send them back for something that surprised at least one member.

QUIET STUDENTS

The questions are answered around the group one at a time, so nobody has to fight for a turn.

MIXED AGES

Younger groups can answer out loud and have one scribe. The commonality still has to be written down to count.

THE REVEAL

If time allows, each group announces its commonality to the class. The weirder, the better received.

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1. What's the first thing you check when you walk into a new room?

2. What food do you refuse to let touch other food on your plate?

3. What's a sound that instantly annoys everyone in your family?

4. What do you save that other people throw away?

5. What's something you've never told anyone is actually easy for you?

6. What tiny superstition do you secretly follow?

CASE SOLVED

We all... _____

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